INFORMATION TO KEEP WITH YOU

My complete treatment handbook

Bevacizumab every 21 days · breast treatment component

Understand your treatment. Know what to expect. Keep your plan to hand.

Displayed calendar
21 days
See the active treatment phase

Regimen source
NCCP 00215
Version 7

Day 1 every 21 days

Inside your handbook

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My name

Hospital / oncology team

Use the urgent instructions and contact numbers in your treatment guide. Your team must replace example numbers before patient use. Your individual treatment plan takes precedence.

CHAPTER 01

Understanding your treatment

IN THIS CHAPTER

Why this treatment is offered, what its medicines do, and how the agreed plan fits your care.

How this medicine supports your treatment

Bevacizumab blocks a signal that helps cancers develop blood vessels. With paclitaxel, it can help delay cancer worsening. The aim in this setting is disease control, with treatment reviewed against benefit and side effects.

TARGETED ANTI-VEGF ANTIBODY

Bevacizumab

Blocks the VEGF blood-vessel growth signal

VEGF promotes new blood vessels → Bevacizumab binds VEGF → Less VEGF signalling supports tumour blood vessels

Binds VEGF, a signal that promotes blood-vessel growth. Blocking VEGF can reduce the blood supply that supports tumour growth; it also affects normal blood vessels and wound healing.

Report bleeding, severe pain, neurological symptoms or wound problems promptly, and attend blood-pressure and urine checks.

Why this treatment may be chosen

Adding bevacizumab to paclitaxel can delay worsening of metastatic breast cancer for some people.

The supporting paclitaxel trial used bevacizumab every two weeks. It did not directly test this every-three-week bevacizumab schedule. Discuss the expected benefit and alternatives for your own situation.

When to get help

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe chest pain, major breathing difficulty, collapse or stroke symptoms need emergency help.

Contact your treating team promptly: Seek urgent help for sudden severe abdominal pain, significant bleeding or coughing blood, chest pain, breathlessness, a swollen painful leg, a severe headache, confusion, seizures, a change in vision, or a rapidly painful/red spreading wound. Follow the chemotherapy emergency plan for fever or feeling acutely unwell.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your agreed out-of-hours pathway

Other hospitals: use the contacts your own team provides.

CHAPTER 02

Your schedule, tests and appointments

IN THIS CHAPTER

Your treatment stages, checks and practical preparations, from before treatment through follow-up.

BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Treatment and checks

These are relative planning stages, not booked appointments or equal time intervals. Extra blood-pressure, urine, heart or anticoagulation checks depend on individual risk and results.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00215 v7 · official regimen · EMA Avastin product information · safety and E2100 Table 10

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Bevacizumab every 21 days · breast treatment component: treatment and checks

Bevacizumab every 21 days · breast treatment component

21-day view



This shows treatment timing, not guaranteed symptom-free days. Your team confirms the active phase and dates.

HER2-negative metastatic breast cancer · with paclitaxel

Bevacizumab infusion on Day 1 of each 21-day cycle with separately prescribed paclitaxel. Continue while the cancer is controlled and treatment is tolerated, with regular review; there is no fixed number of breast-treatment cycles.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	First infusion	Later cycles	Between visits	Pause or change
Bevacizumab treatment NCCP 00215	Confirm breast indication and partner plan	Day 1 infusion after checks	Repeat Day 1 every 21 days while helpful/ tolerated	Partner chemotherapy has separate days	Consultant review before any restart
Blood count / kidney / liver NCCP 00215	Baseline tests	Review results	Before each cycle	Extra tests if needed	Review abnormalities and partner treatment
Blood pressure NCCP 00215	Measure and control blood pressure (BP)	Before and after treatment	Before and after each treatment	More often if raised or symptomatic	Review control before restarting
Urine protein NCCP 00215	Baseline urine test	Review urine result	Before each cycle	24-hour collection if indicated	Recheck protein before agreed restart

Care / check	Before starting	First infusion	Later cycles	Between visits	Pause or change
Heart / anticoagulation NCCP 00215	Heart history; echocardiogram (heart ultrasound) (ECHO) if risk; international normalised ratio (blood-clotting test) (INR) if indicated	Review symptoms and medicines	Warfarin INR before cycles once stable	INR weekly until stable; report symptoms	Individual cardiac and anticoagulant review

What each check is for

1 Confirm treatment scope

Before starting and whenever the partner changes

First-line HER2-negative metastatic breast cancer with paclitaxel. This suite explains the bevacizumab component; paclitaxel and any other treatment need their own plan and assessment.

Ask / act: Confirm the indication, partner and actual prescription.

2

Blood pressure and proteinuria

Baseline, each cycle and extra checks when indicated

These effects can be silent, so attend planned tests even when well.

Ask / act: Agree who books, reviews and acts on each test.

3 Procedures and urgent symptoms

Throughout treatment and treatment breaks

Seek urgent help for sudden severe abdominal pain, significant bleeding or coughing blood, chest pain, breathlessness, a swollen painful leg, a severe headache, confusion, seizures, a change in vision, or a rapidly painful/red spreading wound. Follow the chemotherapy emergency plan for fever or feeling acutely unwell.

Ask / act: Contact the team before procedures or for urgent symptoms.

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Tests and review

Before starting: blood count, kidney and liver tests, urine protein, blood pressure and a heart history/examination. Repeat blood count, kidney/liver tests and urine testing before each cycle; check blood pressure before treatment and after it. Extra checks depend on symptoms and results.

Urine results

Protein in the urine can require a 24-hour collection and additional checks. Your team explains how and when to collect it, and reviews whether treatment can continue.

NCCP 00215 v7 · official regimen

Heart and blood-thinning medicines

An ultrasound of the heart may be considered if you have had certain earlier chemotherapy or chest-wall radiotherapy. If you take warfarin, INR tests are usually weekly until stable and then before each cycle; follow your individual plan.

NCCP 00215 v7 · official regimen

Cancer response

Scans and cancer-response checks follow the individual consultant plan. This guide does not promise a fixed scan or repeat heart-ultrasound schedule.

NCCP 00215 v7 · official regimen

CHAPTER 03

Symptoms and supportive care

IN THIS CHAPTER

Recognising changes, knowing when to call, and using your prescribed supportive-care plan.

Day 1 → Day 21: a general pattern

This is a visual orientation, not a prediction of your personal cycle. It shows when some effects often emerge and which effects are **not** tied to a particular day.

Treatment or check	Timing in this view
Bevacizumab · Day 1	 **Day 1** intravenous (IV) infusion after checks
Symptoms / extra checks	 **Days 1–21** Report early; follow the agreed blood pressure (BP) and urine plan

Different schedules: Bevacizumab repeats every 21 days; the chemotherapy partner can follow a different cycle. Check both plans at every change.

Treatment pauses: A pause for surgery, high blood pressure, proteinuria or another effect needs a new team plan; a calendar alone cannot determine a safe restart.

Why these bands stay broad: This shows one 21-day bevacizumab cycle without calendar dates. Partner paclitaxel days are separately prescribed. The next cycle is reviewed before it starts. Band length does not show likelihood or severity, and the chart cannot tell you whether it is safe to receive treatment. NCCP 00215 v7 · official regimen ↗

There are no guaranteed "safe days". Educational reference; the treating team confirms the prescription and tests. This component guide does not cover all paclitaxel risks or give permission to treat.

Treatment and its aim

Who this guide covers

First-line HER2-negative metastatic breast cancer with paclitaxel. This suite explains the bevacizumab component; paclitaxel and any other treatment need their own plan and assessment.

NCCP 00215 v7 · official regimen

Infusion schedule

The usual bevacizumab reference dose is 15 mg/kg intravenously every 21 days. The first infusion is over 90 minutes; if tolerated, the second can be over 60 minutes and later infusions over 30 minutes. The team checks the actual prescription, blood pressure, urine and other tests before treatment.

NCCP 00215 v7 · official regimen

Evidence and personal choice

The supporting study showed a delay in cancer worsening; a longer overall survival was not established. The team weighs this against side effects and treatment burden. The supporting paclitaxel trial used bevacizumab every two weeks. It did not directly test this every-three-week bevacizumab schedule. Discuss the expected benefit and alternatives for your own situation.

Support and urgent symptoms

Seek urgent help for sudden severe abdominal pain, significant bleeding or coughing blood, chest pain, breathlessness, a swollen painful leg, a severe headache, confusion, seizures, a change in vision, or a rapidly painful/red spreading wound. Follow the chemotherapy emergency plan for fever or feeling acutely unwell.



Blood pressure and urine

Take prescribed blood-pressure medicines as agreed and attend urine checks. If a 24-hour collection is requested, confirm how to collect and return it before the next treatment.

NCCP 00215 v7 · official regimen

Surgery, wounds and teeth

Tell the team about planned operations, dental procedures and any wound that is not healing. Bevacizumab can require a treatment break around procedures; the team sets the timing.

Separate chemotherapy support

Bevacizumab itself usually needs no routine anti-sickness premedication. Paclitaxel has separate allergy-prevention, anti-sickness and symptom plans; keep both plans and the emergency contact details.

NCCP 00215 v7 · official regimen

Pregnancy and breastfeeding

Discuss fertility and effective contraception before treatment and continue contraception during treatment and for at least six months after the last bevacizumab dose. Do not breastfeed during treatment or for at least six months after the final dose. The partner treatment may require additional precautions.

Practical support

Blood pressure and urine

Surgery, wounds and teeth

Separate chemotherapy support

Pregnancy and breastfeeding

Taking tablets / attending treatment

Practical treatment details

Access and procedures

Bevacizumab needs an intravenous cannula or existing suitable central line; the team decides access.

Support contacts

If a visit or test is missed, contact the team for a revised plan rather than rearranging treatment yourself.

Questions to ask

Is this a stand-alone breast treatment?

This breast regimen uses bevacizumab with paclitaxel. Any change to the chemotherapy partner or a continuation plan must be agreed with your oncologist.

How long will I have treatment?

There is no fixed number of breast-treatment cycles. Your team reviews cancer control, side effects and your preferences and agrees when to continue, pause or change.

What happens if urine protein or blood pressure rises?

The team may repeat tests, treat blood pressure or pause bevacizumab. Severe problems may mean stopping it. Do not restart after a pause without an agreed plan.

What if I need an operation or dental work?

Tell the oncology team before the procedure. Bevacizumab can slow healing, and the team must coordinate any treatment break and check healing before restarting.

Explain the plan back: Which days have bevacizumab and paclitaxel, when are blood-pressure and urine checks, which symptoms need urgent help, and who must know about surgery or a wound?

Supportive prescription draft for review. This is a regimen template. It is not an issued patient prescription; individual review and completion are required.

Bevacizumab component · separate partner support

Active medicines: Bevacizumab

Emetogenic risk: Minimal for bevacizumab only

No routine prophylactic antiemetic order is populated for this phase. Agree an individual symptom-treatment plan where needed.

Additional phase-specific support

- No routine bevacizumab antiemetic prophylaxis; assess partner chemotherapy emetic risk separately.
- No routine bevacizumab premedication unless prior hypersensitivity and a reviewed plan. Paclitaxel premedication is separate.
- Anti-diarrhoeal medicines only if required under local policy.
- Maintain blood pressure (BP)/urine, procedure/wound and urgent-contact plans.

Before signing: verify allergies, current medicines, interactions, renal / hepatic function, QT risk, sedation, prior response, total steroid exposure and the rescue-medicine duration. Do not duplicate medicines from another phase.

Individual changes / rescue duration: _____
Prescriber / date: _____ Pharmacy review: _____

Bevacizumab every 21 days · breast treatment component

Bevacizumab infusion on Day 1 of each 21-day cycle with separately prescribed paclitaxel. Continue while the cancer is controlled and treatment is tolerated, with regular review; there is no fixed number of breast-treatment cycles.

Bevacizumab with separately planned chemotherapy · selected medicine-specific effects. Full details and sources are in the complete reference.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Head / vision

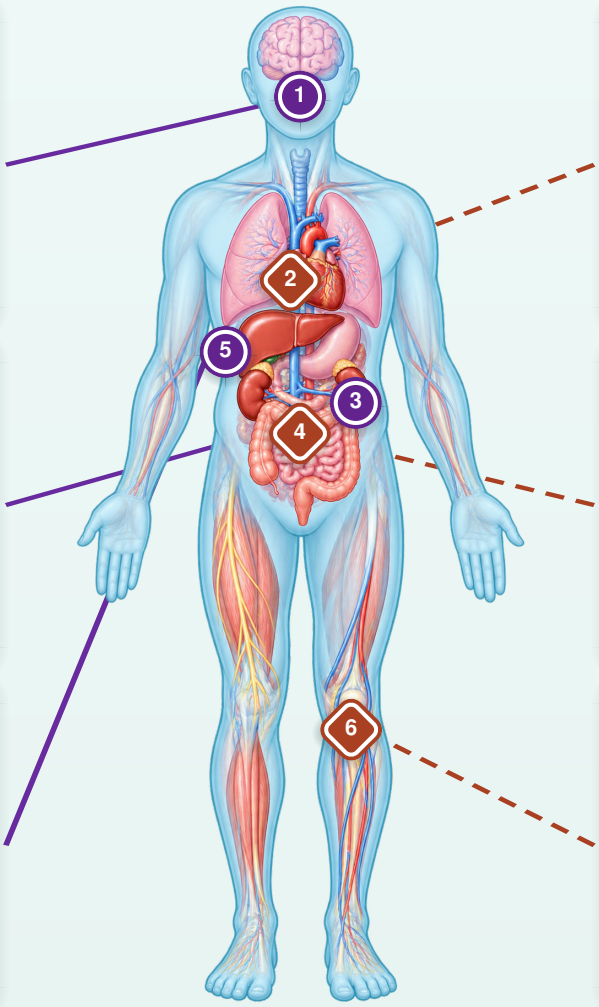
Bevacizumab

Severe headache, confusion, seizures or a change in vision need urgent help.

2 Heart / blood vessels

Bevacizumab

Attend blood-pressure checks; chest pain, breathlessness or a swollen painful leg need urgent help.



3 Kidneys / urine

Bevacizumab

Urine checks look for protein. Report new swelling, foamy urine or reduced urine.

4 Abdomen / bowel

Bevacizumab

Sudden severe abdominal pain needs urgent assessment.

5 Skin / wounds

Bevacizumab

Report bleeding or wounds that are painful, red, spreading or slow to heal.

6 Leg / clots

Bevacizumab

A new swollen painful leg or sudden breathlessness needs urgent help.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Seek urgent help for sudden severe abdominal pain, significant bleeding or coughing blood, chest pain, breathlessness, a swollen painful leg, a severe headache, confusion, seizures, a change in vision, or a rapidly painful/red spreading wound. Follow the chemotherapy emergency plan for fever or feeling acutely unwell. Severe chest pain, major breathing difficulty, collapse or stroke symptoms: 112 / 999.

CHAPTER 04

Sources and further information

IN THIS CHAPTER

The references behind this information and addresses you can use to find further help.

Use this information alongside the plan agreed with your treatment team. Your team confirms your medicines, doses and appointments.

1. **Current NCCP regimen supportive-care section**
   https://healthservice.hse.ie/documents/6940/00215_Bevacizumab_15.pdf
2. **EMA Avastin product information · safety and E2100 Table 10**
   https://www.ema.europa.eu/en/documents/product-information/avastin-epar-product-information_en.pdf